

GREECE 2013

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1. Review of the system

1.1 Average Worker Wage (AW)

The 2013 estimated AW is EUR 20 604.

2. Unemployment Insurance

The unemployment insurance system covers persons who are insured against diseases with a social insurance body and who are insured against unemployment with the Labour Employment Office. The benefits are divided into regular benefits and special allowances. This programme is targeted on employees that became unemployed against their will and are not capable of finding a job relevant to their qualifications.

2.1 Condition for receipt

- The person must be capable of and available for work
- The person must be unemployed unwillingly
- The person must have registered with an employment agency.
- The person must not receive a pension equal to or larger than the minimum pension granted by IKA (Social Insurance Institute)
- The person must not be self-employed.

Under art.44, para2, of L. 3986/2011 a Special Fund for the Self-Employed was established, which will provide a special assistance in cases of proven ending of an occupation and for at least three months. For the actual implementation of this Special Fund, a decision of the Minister of Labour and Social Security, after consultation with the Board of Directors of agencies and opinion of Council for Social Security (S.K.A.) is needed.

2.1.1 Employment conditions

The persons applying for the benefit for the **first time** must have worked for at least 80 days per year in the last two years prior to their application and should also have

- 125 days of employment in the last 14 months prior to applying for the benefit (the last two months prior to the commencement of unemployment are not taken into consideration in the calculation of these 125 working days), or
- 200 days of employment in the last 2 years prior to the dismissal (the last two months prior to the commencement of unemployment are not taken into consideration in the calculation of these 125 working days)

A person applying for **second time** must satisfy the following condition: a contribution record of 125 working days in the last 14 months prior to his/her dismissal (the last two months prior to the commencement of unemployment are not taken into consideration in the calculation of these 125 working days).

As for the employees in the tourism sector (or seasonal workers, e.g. musicians, actors), the following condition must be satisfied:

- 100 working days in the last 12 months prior to the dismissal if the employee worked for two consecutive touristic seasons,
- 100 working days in the last 14 months prior to the dismissal if the employee worked for one touristic season (the last two months prior to the commencement of unemployment are not taken into consideration). The same condition applies also for the construction workers.

2.1.2 Contributions conditions

The system is contributory. The contributions made to the OAED (Manpower Employment Organization) are paid both by the employer and the employee.

2.2 Calculation of benefit amount

2.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

Pursuant to article 5 of Act 3352/07 for the unemployed that were employed in a full-time job or whose monthly wages were higher than the twelve-fold of the daily wage of the unskilled worker, the basic unemployment benefit is defined to 50% of the daily wage of the unskilled worker from January 1st 2007 and from January 1st 2008 to 55% of the daily wage of the unskilled worker.

To the unemployed that were not employed in a full-time job and whose monthly wages were lower than or equal to the six-fold of the daily wage of the unskilled worker, 50% of the basic unemployment benefit is paid, whereas to the unemployed that were not employed in a full-time job and whose monthly wages were higher than the six-fold and lower than or equal to the twelve-fold of the daily wage of the unskilled worker, 75% of the basic unemployment benefit is paid.

Following the decline of the daily wage of the unskilled worker by 22% (art.1, para6, L.4046/2012) the basic daily unemployment benefit decreased also, from 12 March 2012, and currently amounts to 14,40 euros, while the monthly unemployment benefit to 360,00 euros (Ministerial Decision 3800/359/1.3.2012).

The lowest daily unemployment benefit is 7,20 euros and the monthly 180,00 euros.

The unemployment benefit is paid for 25 days per month and increases by 10% for every dependant member of the beneficiary.

2.2.2 Income and earnings disregards

None. The payment of the benefit is interrupted in case there is an income from commercial businesses or liberal professions.

2.3 Tax treatment of the benefit

The unemployment benefit paid by the OAED to the beneficiaries, is tax exempt on condition that the sum of the taxpayer's other income, which is taxable under the general provisions, does not exceed EUR 30.000 annually.

2.4 Benefit duration

The benefit is paid after a waiting period of six days.

The period during which the unemployment benefit is being paid depends upon the contribution record the applicant establishes before becoming unemployed and varies between 5 and 12 months, as follows:

Days of employment (in the 14-month period)	Tourism sector 12-month period	Construction workers (14-month)	Duration (months)
125-149 ¹	100-149	100-149	5
150-179 ²	150-179	150-179	6
180-219 ³	180-219	180-219	8
220-249	220-249	220-249	10
250 or more	250 or more	250 or more	12
210 days and 49+ years old	210 or more	210 and 49+years old	12

1. or 200 in the 2-year period
2. or 250 in the 2-year period
3. or 300 in the 2-year period

2.5 Treatment of particular groups

2.5.1 Young persons

Benefit paid to young persons (aged 20-29)

The benefit is paid to young persons, on condition that these are unemployed and remain included in the list of the unemployed for one year. The benefit amounts to 73,37€ per month and increases by 5,87€ for each dependant (child-spouse), and is paid for a period of 5 months. The benefit aims to support new entrants into the labour market.

Family status	Amount (in €s)
Single parent	73,37
Couple	79,24
Either single parent or a couple with children	5,87 for each child

2.5.2 Pension for uninsured persons older than 65

The uninsured persons that are older than 65, have no assets and whose income does not exceed the OGA(Agricultural Insurance Institute) basic pension, are granted a pension, which is equal to the basic pension granted by the OGA, in the framework of a special account. This is a non-contributory benefit financed from the state budget.

Since January 1st 2013, this pension is based on more stringent conditions.

For the granting of this benefit, the following conditions need to be met cumulatively:

- a)** the completion of 67 years of age (instead of 65 required until 31.12.2012)
- b)** not being entitled to any other pension in Greece or from abroad
- c)** permanent and legal residence in the country for 20 years (before the latest changes in legislation, 15 years were needed from 2015 onwards)
- d)** specific income criteria (individual taxable income up to 4,320 euros and total annual family taxable income up to 8,640 euros).

3. Unemployment Assistance

3.1 Special aids (Conditions and duration)

3.1.1 Special aid after the end of payment of the unemployment allowance

A special allowance, which comprises of 13 basic daily wages of the unemployment benefit (it amounts to 18.46€), is paid to the unemployed who are not temporarily employed following the end of payment of the unemployment benefit, on condition that they remain unemployed and their family income does not exceed a fixed amount (9977.99 € for 2013). This special allowance amounted to 239.98€ (18,46*13).

3.1.2 Special aid after a three-month registration in the unemployed persons list

It is paid to the unemployed, who do not have the prerequisites for a regular benefit (not seasonal workers) and have actually worked for at least 60 days in the year prior to that in which they registered with the OAED. These persons must remain unemployed (registered with the OAED) for 3 months. The benefit is paid every three months in three separate installments in the same year. The payment consists of 15 daily wages of the unemployment benefit, on condition that their family income does not exceed a fixed amount (9977.99 € for 2013). This special benefit amounted to 276,90 € from 01/07/2011 (18,46*15).

3.1.3 Other special benefits – Short-time work benefit

In case of work suspension (usually occurs when a company is financially weak), unemployed people receive by OAED assistance for the period under suspension. This assistance is equal to 10% of the average regular earnings recorded in the last two months of full time employment prior to work suspension. These benefits are not paid for longer than three months per year.

3.2 Income and earnings disregards

None.

3.2.1 Calculation of the benefit

3.2.1.1 Irregular additional payments

No additional benefits are granted.

3.2.1.2 Obligations of family members

The family members are under no obligation.

3.2.2 Income and taxes disregards

None. The payment of the OAED benefit ceases, in the case of an income, by any source, if exceeds a total of 9,684.52 euros.

3.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

No taxation is imposed on special allowances.

3.4 Treatment of particular groups

It is impossible to grant a benefit again

3.4.1 *Young persons*

Benefit granted to young persons (aged 20-29).

The benefit is granted to young persons, on condition they are unemployed and remain registered as unemployed for one year. The benefit amounts to 73,37€ per month and is paid for a period of five months. It aims to support the new entrants into the labour market.

3.4.2 *Long-term unemployed people*

The OAED grants the “long-term unemployed people benefit” to persons between **45 and 65 years of age** who are insured for the unemployment risk, and remain registered as unemployed with the OAED for twelve consecutive months and have exhausted their regular unemployment insurance right after 12 months of payment (irrespective if it happened in the last 12 months or in the past, consecutively or with suspensions), and their family income (increased by 587 Euros for every child under the age of 18) does not exceed 12,000 euros (as from 11 January 2012).

The benefit amounts to 200€ and is paid for twelve months (at most).

The increase of 10% by each dependent person is given only to the “special aid” recipients and not to the recipients of the “long-term unemployed people benefit”.

3.4.3 *Seasonal aid*

This aid is offered to persons belonging to occupational groups employed on a seasonal basis (construction workers, tobacco workers, actors, tile makers, forest workers, musicians, etc). The aid is paid on a yearly basis in the period from 1 October to 20 December. The following prerequisites must be fulfilled:

- The applicant must have actually worked for 50 – 210 days, as the case may be in the pertinent branch in the year prior to the year of payment.
- The applicant must not have actually worked for more days in branches other than the pertinent one in the previous year.
- The total of daily wages in any work must not exceed 240.
- The applicant must not fulfill the preconditions for regular benefit in the period in which the seasonal aid is paid.

Moreover, it has to be noted that workers bound by a dependent working relationship who are employed exclusively by seasonal businesses, such as those specified in article 4, para.2 of Act No. 1545/85, as replaced by article 31 of Act No. 4144/2013, and interpreted by the relevant OAED circulars regarding seasonality (employed in tourism- food related occupations, seasonal firefighters, etc), whose employment relationship has been terminated from 31.8.2013 onwards, are divided into two categories regarding the duration of unemployment benefit entitlement:

a) insured persons who have paid insurance contributions for 100 to 149 days of work, during the time periods (12 or 14 months) that are critical for the entitlement of the benefit, after being employed by enterprises that operate seasonally and who are compulsorily included in a regular unemployment benefit scheme that lasts for 3 months and 5 days (80 days in total)

b) insured persons who have paid insurance contributions for 150 to 200 days of work, during the time periods) that are critical for the entitlement of the benefit, after being employed by enterprises that operate seasonally and who, by submitting an irrevocable formal written statement in accordance with Act No. 1599/86 to the competent OAED KPA, have the possibility to choose to be

included in either the regular unemployment benefit scheme that lasts for 3 months and 5 days, according to the current provision or according to the previous unemployment benefit scheme.

Insured persons of the above category (a), who are compulsorily included in the present regulation, as well as those of the above category (b), who with their irrevocable formal statement, choose to be subsidized in accordance with the current regulation, are excluded from the limitation of 450 days of subsidy during 2013 or 400 days of subsidy during the last four years from 2014 onwards set by para.8 of Act No. 1545/85, which came into force by virtue of article 39, para. 1 of Act No. 3986/2011.

3.4.4 Worker laid off due to insolvency of the employer

The OAED keeps an independent account called “Account for the protection of workers against employers’ insolvency”. The said account aims to pay up to three months earnings unpaid, due to the employer’s insolvency, as provided for in a contract of employment or a dependent working relationship. These earnings are considered and are being taxed as paid services.

4. Social assistance

4.1 EKAS (social solidarity benefit for pensioners)¹:

It is a non-contributory monthly benefit, providing financial support to receivers of old-age, invalidity or survivors' pensions. [The scheme was first introduced in 1996 (Law 2434)]. This allowance is financed by the State Budget.

The recently passed **Law 3996/05.08.2011** on the restructuring of the Labour Inspectorate (SEPE) provides information on EKAS (**Article 34** – redefining the EKAS eligibility conditions). More information/ guidance on EKAS provision (in relation to Article 34 of the above mentioned Law) is provided by the encyclical circulated by the General Secretariat of Social Security on August 16, 2011).

Conditions that must be met cumulatively by the pensioners in order to receive the EKAS:

- Old-age and survivors pensioners must have (on 1 January 2011) at least 60 years of age
- The total net annual income from pensions (main pensions, supplementary pensions and benefits), salaries, wages and other allowances may not exceed EUR 8,472.09.
- The total annual individual taxable income may not exceed EUR 9,884.11
- The total annual family taxable income may not exceed EUR 15,380.90.
- The total gross pension (main and supplementary) paid the month that the 3996 Law becomes effective may not exceed 850 euros.
- Pensioners should reside permanently in Greece

The payable amount of EKAS is as follows:

Amount of Income	Amount of EKAS (in Euros) per month
Up to 7,715.65	230.00
7,715.66 – 8,018.26 euros	172.50
8,018.27 – 8,219.93 euros	115.00
8,219.94 – 8,472.09 euros	57.50
8,472.10-9,200.00 euros *	30.00

*The total annual family taxable income may not exceed EUR 13,500

Low income pensioners of the public sector are also provided with EKAS, according to Law 2453/1997 (article 1) as amended by the laws 2592/1998 (article 25), 2768/1999 (article 1) and 4151/2013 (article 4, para8). The eligibility criteria and the amounts of EKAS are the same as described above.

4.2 Programmes to support persons with disabilities - Non-institutional Benefit

There is no general framework, but there are provisions for persons in great need. The Ministry of Health and Social Solidarity implements 10 programmes of financial support for persons with disabilities depending on the kind, the category or the seriousness of the disability.

Furthermore, in accordance with the provisions of Act No1140/1981 and Joint Ministerial Decision No61384/6138/19-5-1983 of the Ministers of Defense, Interior, Justice, Finance, Health and Social Solidarity and of Public Order, as amended and in force, active employees of Local Self-Government Agencies suffering from quadriplegia or paraplegia as well as their family members suffering from the same diseases are entitled to a non-institutional benefit paid by either the body which is the employer of the beneficiary (Local Self-Government Agency) or by the insurance body of the beneficiary.

¹ There are future policy changes described in the chapter 12.1.

In order for the Local Self – Government Agency to grant the said benefit, the following preconditions are necessary: a) the beneficiary is an active employee, b) the beneficiary does not receive a benefit from another source and c) the beneficiary is not hospitalized. The benefit is granted from the LSGA's budget. For the quadriplegic and the paraplegic persons insured in the public sector, the benefit in 2011 amounted to 742 euro.

On the other hand, concerning the social security funds under the competence of the General Secretariat for Social Security, and more precisely IKA-ETAM, the non-residential benefit for the paraplegia and quadriplegia is set to 20 daily wages of an unskilled worker as was in force on 31.12.2011.

5. Housing benefits

5.1 Conditions for receipt

By virtue of Act No. 4046/2012 (O.G. 28, A'/14-02-2012) and more specifically chapter 4 (structural reforms to enhance growth), **the Workers' Fund and the Workers' Housing Organization have been abolished**, on the grounds that they were special purpose bodies dealing with social costs that are not a priority. Ministerial Cabinet Decree No 7/28-02-2012 (O.G. 39, A'/29-02-2012), stipulates that the competencies of the abolished bodies are transferred to the OAED, where a Special Fund is established to which all cash flow and revenue of the abolished bodies are transferred in order to meet operating costs as well as costs related exclusively to prior commitments, provisions and programs. **The OAED does not undertake the implementation of new programs and granting of provisions, except the operation of nurseries.** By virtue of the same Ministerial Cabinet Decree a five-member Single Temporary Steering Committee has been established whose task is to deal with commitments and rights, without having the right to assume new commitments arising from new programs and provisions.

Therefore, with regard to the Workers' Housing Organization, the only data that can be given is on the granting of rent allowances, in 2012, **which actually relates to the settlement of outstanding claims submitted in 2011.** In particular, **25.285 beneficiaries received subsidies of a total amount of 31.950.439 euros.**

Ministry of Education, and Religious Affairs

Tertiary education undergraduates are granted an **annual housing allowance of 1.000€**, in accordance with the provisions of Act No.3220/04 and two Ministerial Decisions (by virtue of the second decision, the procedure or criteria for granting the housing allowance has been amended). The said allowance is paid for as long as the studies last, according to the rules of procedure of each department. Tertiary education graduates, who attend a course aiming at obtaining a second or a Master's degree, are not entitled to the above allowance, irrespective of how they have been admitted to the said course.

There is no specific age limit for a beneficiary, in order to be entitled to the allowance, provided that the legal preconditions are met. The student must reside in a rented house, which, due to his/ her studies, is in a city other than the one of his/her main residence, where neither his parents nor he/ she have the full ownership or the usufruct of another residence. Those who reside in university student halls and boarding houses are not entitled to the allowance. In order for the allowance to be granted, the annual family income of the previous fiscal year must not exceed the amount of 30.000Euro, increased by 3.000Euro for each dependent child, beyond the first one.

The housing (student) allowance of 1.000 euros granted annually under the provisions of article 10 of Act No. 3220/2004, cannot be not seized, is granted in full without any deduction in favour of the State or a third party and is not subject to taxation.

By virtue of article 40 of Act No. 4186/2013 (O.G. 193/A'/17-09-2013) from the academic year 2013-2014, interest-free loans and financial aid can be provided to undergraduate students by the institutions they attend, in order to meet their special educational needs, based on their individual or family status and the performance in their studies. The extent, the procedure and the conditions under which such loans and aids are granted, are determined by Presidential Decree issued following a proposal of the Ministers of Finance and of Education and Religious Affairs,

5.2 Calculation of the amount of the benefit

5.2.1 Calculation of the gross benefit (per month)

Type of family	Monthly Benefit	Annual Benefit
Single persons and couples	115€	1.380€
Couples with one dependent child	140€	1.680€
Couples with two dependent children	165€	1.980€
Couples with three dependent children	215€	2.580€
Couples with four dependent children	215€	2.580€

The amount of the 215€ benefit increases by 25€ per month for each dependent child beyond the fifth child (Children are considered as dependent until they complete their 21st year of age, whereas, if they study at Universities or Technological Educational Institutes or at post-compulsory secondary education state schools, until they complete their 25th year of age. There is no age limitation for children who are incompetent for any type of work)

5.2.2 Income and earnings disregards**5.2.3 Costs eligible for housing benefits****5.3 Tax treatment of the benefit****5.4 Benefit duration****5.5 Treatment of special groups****Housing Assistance Program for elderly persons over 65**

The Ministry of Health and Social Solidarity implements the housing assistance program to single, uninsured and financially weak elderly persons over 65 as well as to couples of uninsured and financially weak elderly persons for whom it has been proven that they do not own a house and live in rented accommodation and pays a housing allowance in the form of rent.

The term elderly comprises all persons of 65 years of age or older. The beneficiaries can be either single elderly persons, i.e. persons who live alone, or couples of elderly persons who live alone. In the case of couples, at least one of them must have completed the age of 65. In each case the beneficiaries must

a) be uninsured, i.e. they must not receive pension from any insurance body, with the exception of elderly persons who, according to the provisions of Act No1296/82 and of article 17 of Act No1422/84, receive the pension granted to uninsured persons through the special fund of the Agricultural Insurance Institute (OGA) and can be entitled to housing assistance.

b) be financially weak, according to the provisions of Legislative Decree No57/73, and must not have any income coming from any domestic or foreign source or any real estate which can give them the ability to pay for their housing expenses.

c) not have their own house and live in a rented accommodation.

The program is implemented by the department or the section of Social Welfare of the competent Municipality. In addition to the necessary documentation that should be presented by the would-be beneficiaries, a report written by a social worker of the competent Social Welfare Department mentioning the socioeconomic status of the uninsured elderly person together with a proposal of whether he/she should be entitled or not to receive housing assistance are also required.

For those who are deemed to be beneficiaries, the benefit is paid to the owners of the residences themselves, following the signing of a private agreement between the social welfare service of the competent Municipality and the owner. The amount of the monthly benefit is determined each time by a ministerial decision. According to Ministerial Decision NoP3a/F.18/G.P. 63731 (O.G.931/B/21-05-2008), this amount is 362 euros for the year 2011.

The elderly beneficiaries do not pay tax on this housing assistance benefit. The owners of the residences are taxed on their incomes according to the provisions that apply for all taxpayers.

6. Family support

6.1 Family Allowances

A general scheme is applied, which is supplemented by the employer. The family allowance is granted by OAED to working parents, IKA-insured workers and employees who are paid a monthly salary and who, according to a law, collective labour agreement, in-business regulation or other legal provisions, do not receive from their employer a child allowance that is higher than the family allowance of the DLOEM-OEAD fund

Moreover, for 2012 the monthly family benefit still applies to public servants, employees of the Local Self Government Agencies of A' and B' degree and employees of other bodies of the public sector. This provision is granted depending on the beneficiaries' family status (article 17, of Act No. 4024/2011) as follows:

For an employee with unmarried and underaged children or children incapable of work (at a rate of disability of at least 50%) or children studying in secondary (up to the age of 19), or higher education (up to the age of 24), the provision granted is set at 50 euros for one child, 70 euros in total for two children, 120 euros in total for three children, 170 euros in total for four children and is increased by 70 euros for every additional child.

The above family provision is also granted to the pensioners of the public sector who have retired from service from 1-11-2011 onwards (Act No. 4024/2011).

6.1.1 Conditions for receipt

The preconditions for receiving the family allowance is that the beneficiary must have actually worked for fifty days in the year preceding to that in which the relevant application is submitted or a two-month regular subsidy due to unemployment or a two-month continuous inability to work.

The children for whom allowance is granted must:

- be under 18 years of age or under 22 years of age, in case of students
- if they are incapable of working, for as long as their incapability lasts
- be single
- reside either in Greece or in another EU Member State.

6.1.2 Calculation of the benefit amount

General scheme

The amounts of allowances (per month), as readjusted for the year 2011, have been formulated as follows:

Number of Children	Amount €
1 child	8.22€
2 children	24.65€
3 children	55.47€
4 children	67.38€
For each additional child	11.30€
so, 5 children	78.68€

There is a special allowance for parents with 3 or more children	
3 rd child (up to the age of 6)	177 € monthly
3 rd child (over 6 years old and up to the age of 23)	44€ monthly

Families with 4 or more children(up to the age of 23)	44€ monthly per child
Life-Long pension to mothers with more than 3 children	€ 102 monthly

By virtue of Act No3631/08 a monthly benefit is granted to mothers, who have or give birth to three living children, for each unmarried child under the age of 23. The monthly benefit is 44 euros for each child and equals to the benefit paid each time for every child of a family with many children. Since 1.1.2012 all family allowances for families with three children or more and family income more than €45.000 are abolished (para22,art 27, Law 4052/12(O.G.41A/1-3-2012).

The employer usually pays each worker (married or not) with 5% of the gross income adding 10% for the spouse. The amount paid for the spouse is independent of her status of employment and income.

As far as it concerns public servants:

Family allowances (depending on the number of children) are also provided monthly for public servants (€50 for one child, €70 for two children, €120 for three children, €170 for four children increased by €70 for every additional child)/Law 4024/2011(O.G.226A/27.10.2011)

Treatment of special groups

The amounts of family allowances increase by 3,67€ per month and by 44,04 per year for each child in the following cases:

- For not recognized children born out of marriage
- For children with disabilities
- For parentless orphans
- When the beneficiary is a widow
- When the beneficiary has a disabled spouse
- When the beneficiary's spouse is a soldier

6.2 Pregnancy and post-natal period benefit

During maternity leave, women employees receive the benefit from:

- the insurance body that they are insured with
- the Hellenic Manpower Employment Organization (OAED) and
- their employer.

a) During leave, women are paid by the Social Insurance Institute. The IKA-ETAM subsidizes the women directly insured with it for 56 days before the presumed date of confinement (pregnancy benefit) and for 63 days after it (post-natal period benefit), i.e. for a total of 119 days (17 weeks), according to the provisions of article 11 of Act No2874/2000 (O.G. 286/A'). During this maternity leave, the insured woman is granted 50% of the imputed daily wage of the insurance class to which she belongs, on the basis of the average earnings of the last 30 days of the previous year, as well as the child allowance (10% for each child and up to 40% maximum). In this case, the minimum amount of the benefit equals to the 2/3 of the insured woman's earnings and the maximum amount of the said benefit,

b) The Greek Manpower Employment Organisation pays a supplementary amount to ensure the mother's income reaches the level before the leave.

This benefit is also granted to all foreign mothers who fulfill the above-mentioned preconditions and legally reside in Greece.

c) Additionally, they receive an amount from their employer that refers to fifteen-day wages or one monthly salary, depending on their previous service to this employer; the employer is entitled to deduct from the said benefit any amount the woman worker may receive from her insurance body as a subsidy for the same period of time.»

6.3 Post confinement care benefit

Since 2012, birth grant is replaced by a lump sum birth grant of €900 for the birth of one child, €1200 € for twins and €1600 for triplet pregnancy, provided that delivery occurs without any cost for the Insurance Body (the grant is paid for expenses incurred for medical services in a private hospital.)Benefit for the cost of in vitro fertilisation (paid for each attempt/maximum four times) is also granted according the above mentioned regulation.

Financial benefits are also granted due to maternity to working women that are not eligible to receive them from the insurance body or are uninsured. The said benefits are granted for a period of six weeks prior to the childbirth and aim at securing satisfactory living standards. These benefits amount to 440,20€ (220,10€ before the childbirth and 220,10€ after it paid by municipalities.(Law 1302/82,art4, para5).

6.4 Special Maternity Leave

By virtue of Act 3655/ 2008, art.142, a special maternity leave was instituted. Mothers insured at the IKA – ETAM and working with a fixed-term or non fixed-term contract, are entitled to this additional leave. As specified under art.36 Law 3996/2011, the beneficiaries for the special maternity leave, are the private sector employees who earn the minimum benefits of art.9 of the 2004-2005 National General Collective Agreement concerning the child-care leave (reduced-time period).

The additional leave is granted after the end of the maternity leave or the end of the 3.5 months leave granted in substitution of the reduced-time period (child-care leave), according to art.9 of the National General Collective Agreement 2004-2005. The special maternity leave starts the day the maternity leave or the above mentioned child care leave of the 3.5 months ends.

OAED is obligated to pay a monthly benefit to the working mother that equals to the minimum wage as set by the National General Collective Agreement, as well as the proportion of holiday benefits and leave benefits according to the minimum wage.

According to Law 3896/(Article 16) the worker who has obtained a maternity leave /or *special maternity leave* shall be entitled, upon expiry of such leave, to return to her job or to an equivalent post on the same employment terms and conditions and to enjoy any improvement of working conditions, to which she would be entitled during her absence. Additionally the employer cannot deny hiring a woman due to her pregnancy or maternity. Law 3896/2010 (article 20)

Additionally, by Law 3996/2011(Article 36) women that take the special maternity leave are also insured for medical care. Regarding women working part-time for up to four hours per day or up to 13 days per month on average during the six months before their pregnancy leave, the amount paid is half the one mentioned above.

6.5 Support of unprotected children scheme

Through this scheme, a monthly benefit of 44,02€ is paid to each unprotected child up to age of 16, provided that the monthly income of the family that the child is living with does not exceed the amount of 2820€ for a three-member family (this amount increases by 250€ for each member of the family beyond the third one). This benefit is granted to the following cases:

- Children left orphans of both parents
- Children left orphans of their father

- Children whose father cannot respond to their subsistence and upbringing needs due to physical or mental disability (67% and more), suffering from diseases that are indicated in detail at art. 1, P.D. 108/83, moral demerit, abandonment, imprisonment, military service, AIDS,
- Children born outside of marriage and exposed.

This “unprotected child allowance[Law 4051/1960 (OG 68, A’)]” is paid by municipalities

Financial assistance is not provided to unprotected children found in institutions that provide free of charge services and care and operate all year round at a 24-hour basis.

6.6 Other family support schemes

- Low income support for households in mountainous and disadvantaged areas (law 3016/2002, article 27, par.2). An allowance of 600 euros is granted per year for annual income up to 3.000 euros and an allowance of 300 euros per year, for annual income up to 4.700 euros.
- Low income support for families with children attending compulsory education and not exceeding 16 years of age (law 3016/2002, article 27, par.3 as amended by law 3879/2010, article 28, par. 1). An allowance of 300 euros is granted per year and for annual family income up to 3.000 euros.

7 Child care benefits

In 2010-2011 the OEE (Workers' Fund) in 24 Day Nurseries hosted in total 1.221 children, of which 391 in the prefecture of Attica and 830 in the region (age 8 months- 5 years).

As far as the childcare programmes are concerned, a scheme is followed in accordance with the rules of modern preprimary education and pilot educational, training and entertainment programmes are carried out in the nurseries, such as educational walks, action plans on intercultural education, environmental education, etc. During 2010-2011, 145 educators, as well as 80 persons as administrative and assistant personnel, were employed.

The operational costs (catering-minor expenses-gifts for children) of the OEE Infant Nurseries for the fiscal period 2010-2011 were as follows:

- Standard operational costs: 568,910.40 euro

During 2011 there were no costs for the end of school year manifestations, for educational excursions and for Christmas and New Year's celebrations.

Furthermore, we would like to inform you that, since the summer of 2008, the OEE has incorporated a new scheme into its activities, whose objective is to provide benefited women with posts, concerning the care and accommodation of infants, preschoolers, children and adolescents, in structures (infant nurseries, infant nurseries of integrated care, day nurseries, centers for children's participation in creative activities – KDAP, and centers for the creative activities of children with disabilities – KDAP-MEA) and which aims at increasing the employability of women and their equal opportunities regarding access to work.

Within the framework of the said scheme, during the period 2009-2010, 539 structures participated (with 17.785 offered jobs), each of which implementing their own training programs. The number of women beneficiaries amounts to 14.888, while the number of children hosted, under agreements, amounts to 14.245.

Regarding the child care expenses paid, the parents do not bear the economic burden in none of the two schemes implemented by the Workers' Fund (OEE).

Moreover, we would like to inform you that the Ministry of Education and Religious Affairs, Culture and Sport is responsible for the operation of all kindergartens in the country. In accordance with O.G. 272/A/21-12-2006, article.73 from 2007 the attendance of children aged 5 to kindergarten is mandatory. Kindergartens also admit children aged 4 on condition that the places are not filled by children aged 5. More specifically, by virtue of the relevant circular on the planning of educational tasks, for the school year 2011-2012, the Ministry of Education makes clear that: «the attendance of preschoolers who till the 31st of December 2010 have reached the age of five, is now mandatory, in accordance with article 73 of Act No.3518/2006 as well as with the Ministerial Decision dated 17-11-2011, that determines how the attendance of preschoolers will be certified. This Certificate is one of the documents required for enrollment at the first grade of a primary school. For the enrollment of preschoolers aged 4 the provisions of P.D. 200/1998 apply. They are admitted to kindergartens that still have free places after the enrollment of all children aged 5.

7.1 Out-of-pocket childcare fees paid by parents

As far as the imposition of catering fees for the municipal day nurseries is concerned, it is provided for by the provisions of article 9 of the Model Regulation for the Operation of Municipal Day and Infant Nurseries (Joint Ministerial Decision No.16065/22-4-2002, O.G.B'497), in accordance with which the Administrative Board of the legal entity – following a fully documented consent of the relevant Local Self-Government Agency (OTA), which is in conformity with the social nature of the services provided – may define the criteria for the imposition of a monthly payment (catering fees) to

the families of the hosted children, depending on their financial state. The same Administrative Board decision defines the cases of families that may be exempted from the payment of this financial contribution, or that may make reduced payments.

It is noted that the decision to impose catering fees is subsumed in the framework of the OTA and their respective legal entities' financial and administrative independence.

The Nurseries that take into account the family income, in order to determine the amount to be paid as catering fees, use many different scales regarding both the income and the fees.

As far as the amount of paid catering fees per parents' income scale is concerned, there are variations regarding the amount of catering fees imposed by Crèches [Day Nurseries] and Infant Nurseries, not only among income categories, but also within the same category, and the fees vary from 30Euros up to more than 80Euros.

In order to improve the living conditions of the children and the standards of services offered, parents pay catering expenses depending on their family income.

Table : Catering expenses (in €) in 2008

Family income (in €)	Catering expenses (in €)*
Up to 5.898,4	Free
5.898,41 – 8.804,11	20,54
8.804,11 – 11.738,81	26,41
11.738,81 – 14.673,51	35,22
14.673,51 – 17.608,22	44,02
17.608,22 – 20.542,92	52,82
Over 20.542,92	64,56

* half expenses are paid for the second child.

Families with more than three children and parents with disabilities (more than 67%) are exempt from the obligation to pay catering expenses when their income is up to 20.542,92€ (when the income is more than 20.542,92€, the expenses for the third child are 20,54€ and 10,27€ for every child beyond the third one). **It is not always mean-tested.**

7.2 Child-care benefits

By virtue of para5 of article 1 of Act3296/2004, the tax relief of 15% on the expenses for Day and Infant Nurseries has been repealed.

8 Allowances depending on employment

None.

9 Allowances for single-parent families

There is a fixed allowance for children without financial support. Please, refer to family allowances.

10 Tax system

10.1 Income tax planning

10.1.1 Tax allowances and credits

1. By virtue of article 9, para. 2 of Act No. 2238/1994 (Income Tax Code), as in force after being replaced by the provisions of Act No.4110/2013 (O.G.17 A'), for income earned and expenses incurred during financial year 2014 (income earned in 2013), based on the tax scale for employees – pensioners, the arising amount of the tax liability is reduced as follows:

a) for income up to and including twenty one thousand euros (21.000) by two thousand one hundred (2.100) euros. If the arising amount of the tax liability is less than two thousand one hundred (2.100) euros, the amount of the reduction is limited to the amount of the tax liability.

b) for income over twenty one thousand euros (21.000), the amount of the reduction mentioned in case (a) is reduced by hundred (100) euros per thousand (1.000) euros of income and up to the sum of two thousand one hundred (2.100) euros.

In order to facilitate tax cross-checks and combat tax evasion, the above mentioned tax reduction depends on the submission of receipts issued in accordance with the provisions of the Code of Tax Reporting of Transactions or in EU countries, for expenses on goods and services made by the taxpayers themselves, their spouses or their dependent children. The amount of receipts for expenses that is required to be submitted equals to twenty five percent (25%) of the declared and taxable personal income and up to ten thousand five hundred (10.500) euros. If the required amount of receipts is not submitted, tax shall be increased by the positive difference between the amount of receipts required, up to the maximum of 10.500 euros, and the amount of receipts submitted multiplied by 22%. Civil servants serving abroad outside the European Union, persons living in nursing homes, psychiatric institutions and prisoners are exempt from the obligation to submit receipts.

2. Moreover, in accordance with the provisions of article 9, para 3 of the Income Tax Code, the arising amount of the tax liability, based on the tax scale for employees – pensioners, in addition to the above mentioned reduction, is further reduced by 10% of all the below mentioned expenses:

✓ costs of medical and hospital care of the taxpayers and other persons dependent on them with regard to the amounts that are not covered by the social security funds and/or insurance companies and exceed (5%) of the taxable income. The amount of the reduction may not exceed 3.000 €.

✓

The following are mainly considered as costs of medical and hospital care: fees paid to doctors and medical centers, hospital costs paid to hospitals or private clinics, costs for medication, fees paid to nurses for services provided to patients during their treatment in a hospital or clinic or at home, costs for artificial limbs, costs of hospital care for children with disabilities (disability degree of 40% and more), amount equal to fifty percent (50%) of the cost paid to elderly people care businesses that operate legally. Moreover, expenses on medical and hospital care for children specified in article 7 of the Income Tax Code (dependants), in case they are paid by the parent who does not live with them due to being divorced with the other parent, are also included.

✓ the amount of alimony ordered and paid by the one spouse to the other, which is his/her taxable income. The amount of tax reduction may not exceed 1.500 €.

✓ amounts paid by the taxpayers as donations to the State, the National Social Cohesion Fund, churches, monasteries of Mount Athos, the Ecumenical Patriarchate of Constantinople, welfare institutions non-profit making unions that offer education services and grant scholarships, Greek public bodies corporate and public entities under private law that are legally established or will be

established for charitable purposes the non-profitable Greek public entities under private law that are legally established or will be established for cultural purposes, etc.

✓ the value of medical devices and ambulances donated to state and municipal health facilities and hospitals that are legal entities under private law and receive grants from the State Budget.

The reduction is made on condition that the amounts of the above donations exceed a total of 100 €. The total amount of donations on which the reduction is calculated may not exceed (5%) of the total taxable income, in accordance with the general provisions. The above provisions on donations also apply to donations to respective state bodies and legal entities in other EU Member-States and EEA countries.

3. Exceptionally, the arising amount of the tax liability based on the three tax scales (employees - pensioners, self-employed, income from real estate and securities) is reduced by two hundred (200) euros, for specific categories of beneficiaries and under the conditions set by the relevant provisions (people with a disability of 67% and more, disabled officers or soldiers, officers in a state of war availability, victims of war, those who receive pension from the State as national resistance or civil war invalids or victims).

10.1.2 Definition of taxable income

For income tax purposes, there are six categories of taxable income: income from immovable property (category A-B), income from movable property (category C), income from business (category D), income from agriculture (category E), income from employment (category F) and income from professional services or other sources (category G).

Net income is computed separately within each category with tax rules that vary across income categories. Losses in one category may be set off against income of another category. If the declared income is not accepted as the base for the tax assessment, the tax authorities can base the assessment on the presumptive income, which is the minimum amount of income required to cover the taxpayer's main living expenses.

Employment income (category F) is subject to withholding tax. The tax is withheld by the employer and is calculated by applying the taxpayer's progressive income tax scale. The employer calculates the withholding tax on the basis of the taxpayer's annual net salary (net of social security contributions). The withholding tax is then reduced by 1.5 per cent of the total amount of taxes due. The resulting tax is the annual tax due, 1/14 of which constitutes the monthly withholding tax for the private sector's employees (every employee receives 14 monthly salaries per year, i.e. 12 monthly wages plus 1 salary as Christmas bonus, ½ salary as Easter bonus and ½ salary as summer vacation bonus). For the employees of the public sector, the monthly withholding tax is calculated approximately as 1/12 of the annual tax due. If the taxpayer's final tax liability (derived from the annual declared income) exceeds the aggregate of the amounts already withheld or prepaid, the remaining tax is generally payable in three equal bimonthly installments. Any excess tax paid or withheld will be refunded.

10.1.3 Tax scale

a) income generated from salaries, pensions, and salaries after having issued an invoice or receipt for the provision of services is subjected to tax in accordance with the following scale:

SCALE FOR EMPLOYEES - PENSIONERS

Income band (euro)	Tax rate %	Tax on the band (euro)	Total	
			Income (euro)	Tax (euro)
25.000	22%	5.500	25.000	5.500

17.000	32%	5.440	42.000	10.940
Over 17.000	42%			

b) Income generated from sole proprietorship and liberal profession is subjected to tax in accordance with the following scale:

SCALE FOR SELF-EMPLOYED

Income band (euro)	Tax rate %	Tax on the band (euro)	Total	
			Income (euro)	Tax (euro)
50.000	26%	13.000	50.000	13.000
Over 50.000	33%			

- The tax rate for the first band of the above scale is reduced by 50% and up to an income of 10.000 euros for new commercial sole proprietorships or new liberal professionals who have declared start of business activity for the first time from 01.01.2013 onwards and for the first three (3) years of activity.
- More specifically, income generated from agricultural sole proprietorships is subjected to tax at a rate of thirteen percent (13%), while for fiscal year 2014 (income earned in 2013) the scale for employees-pensioners will apply to income generated from agricultural sole proprietorships.
- c) Rental income as well as income from securities is subjected to tax in accordance with the following scale:

SCALE FOR INCOME FROM REAL ESTATE AND SECURITIES

taxed in accordance with the general provisions

Income band (euro)	Tax rate %	Tax on the band (euro)	Total	
			Income (euro)	Tax (euro)
12.000	10%	1.200	12.000	1.200
Over 12.000	33%			

10.1.4 Special solidarity contribution

A special solidarity contribution has been introduced (Law 3986/2011 article 29) in 2011. This contribution has been applied just in 2011 and it will be incorporated in the income tax system in 2012.

The calculations according the below table :

Total net income	Special contribution (%)	Special contribution (€)
12.001 - 20.000	1% of the total amount	120 - 200
20.001 - 50.000	2% of the total amount	400 - 1.000
50.001 - 100.000	3% of the total amount	1.500 - 3.000
100.000 -	4% of the total amount	4.000 -

The special solidarity contribution mentioned in article 29 of Act No.3986/2011 is imposed on natural persons' incomes over 12.000 €, generated during tax years 2010 up to and including 2014 and declared in the income tax return forms for the respective financial years 2011-2015. A natural

person's annual total net individual income, either actual or imputed, taxable or exempt, is taken into account for this contribution.

The following categories are excluded and disregarded income for the imposition of the special solidarity contribution:

- Income of persons who are totally blind and persons with severe motor disabilities at a rate of 80% and more,
- compensation for termination of employment relationship,
- lump-sum benefits paid by welfare funds and insurance organizations and lump-sums paid as financial aids to civil servants.

Furthermore, the long-term unemployed who are registered with the OAED unemployment registers, as well as those who receive unemployment benefits by the above mentioned organization are excluded on condition that they have no actual income at the time when the unemployment certificate was issued.

10.2 Treatment of family income

Married persons (spouses) are taxed separately on their own separate income, but are required to submit a joint tax return.

10.3 Social insurance contribution scale

The average contributions rate paid by workers and employers to social insurance bodies is calculated on their gross income as follows:

	Employer	Employee	Total
1. Social Insurance Organisation (IKA)	18.43	9.22	27.65
2. Subsidiary Social Insurance Fund (ETEAM)	3.00	3.00	6.00
3. Other Funds	6.03 ²	4.28	11.41
Total	27.46	16.50	43.96

Contributions are calculated on the basis of the monthly salary or wages paid but within the limits specified in the National General Collective Employment Agreement. Monthly gross remuneration includes salaries and wages, fringe benefits and bonuses and any profit distributions to employees. A ceiling of EUR 2 432.25 per month applies for individuals who have started working prior to 1-1-1993 (2010-ceiling). On the other hand, for individuals who have started working after 1-1-1993, the social security contributions ceiling is EUR 5 546.80. It should be noted that since 12.11.2012 there is a unique ceiling set for both categories of employees and it amounts to 5 546.80 euro.

The aforementioned rates and earnings are also taken into account for the calculation of the contributions on Christmas and Easter bonuses, as well as on the holiday bonus, on which separate contributions are paid to IKA-ETAM.

10.4 Scale of social insurance contributions to health bodies:

Persons insured with health bodies are divided into the old insured and the new insured, depending on the date on which they started paying contributions calculated on their remuneration, as follows:

² According to the par. IA.6.9 and IA.6.10 of the article one of the law 4093/2012, since 1 Nov. 2012, the contribution rate of the employer decreased by 1.1 percentage points.

1. **The old insured** are the persons firstly insured by 31-12-1992, and
2. **The new insured** are the persons firstly insured after 01-01-1993.

Pursuant to Act No2084/1992, a unified rate of contributions to illness – maternity insurance has been established for all wage earners and self-employed persons, as follows:

- Wage earners - 2,55%, and
- Self- employed persons - 7,65% or 6,45%, depending on the insurance category, to which they belong.

The rate of contributions to bodies, with which self-employed persons are insured and **which do not grant illness benefits in cash**, is set at 6,45%.

In case the rate of contributions to health bodies and illness sectors was larger before the promulgation of Act No.2084/1992, the larger rate continues to be paid for both the old and the new insured.

The contributions paid for the year 2010 to the ETAA - Unified Fund for the Independently Employed (with which physicians, lawyers, engineers, notaries are insured) are the same as those for the previous year, as follows:

1st	693.35 euro
2nd	852.63 euro
3rd	1,010.86 euro
4th	1,168.60 euro
5th	1,319.65 euro
6th	1,435.66 euro
7th	1,547.81 euro
8th	1,659.99 euro
9th	1,772.15 euro
10th	1,884.34 euro
11th	1,996.51 euro
12th	2,108.67 euro
13th	2,220.85 euro
14th	2,333.02 euro

The contributions for both the old and the new insured with the OAEE – Insurance Organization for Freelancers for the year 2010 are the same as those for the previous year, as follows:

1st	762.04 euro
2nd	930.71 euro
3rd	1,111.02 euro
4th	1,212.92 euro
5th	1,399.06 euro
6th	1,577.93 euro
7th	1,687.28 euro
8th	1,824.48 euro
9th	1,947.75 euro
10th	2,071.08 euro
11th	2,194.35 euro
12th	2,317.62 euro
13th	2,440.96 euro
14th	2,564.24 euro

11. Part-time employment

11.1 Special rules governing financial assistance to the part-time employed

The part-time employment scheme under Act No. 3250/2004 was concluded in 2012. No change to the institutional framework governing the part-time employees was made for as long as it lasted within that year.

11.2 Special rules concerning taxation and social contributions regarding part-time employment

None.

12 Policy development

12.1 Policy changes introduced: 2nd July 2012 – 1st July 2013

Unemployment Assistance

According to Law 3986/11, article 39, para.1, from 1.1.2013, the *daily unemployment benefits within the previous four years*, can not be more than four hundred fifty (450). If within four years the unemployed is subsidized for a period of less than four hundred fifty (450) daily unemployment benefits, he can be subsidized for the remaining number of daily benefits (up to 450). Additionally, from 1.1.2014 the daily unemployment benefits can not be more than four hundred (400) in a period of four years.

Under art.44, para2, of Law 3986/2011 a Special Fund for the “**Unemployed - Self-Employed**” was established, which will provide a **special assistance to self employed people, in cases of ending of their occupation**. For the actual implementation of this Special Fund, a new legislation is about to be introduced by the Ministry of Labour, Social Security and Welfare, setting the amount of payment, the income and insurance criteria and the duration that the benefit will be granted.

Long-term unemployed people

Law 4093/2012 "Approval of Medium Term Fiscal Strategy 2013-2016 - Urgent Measures for the Application of Law 4046/2012 and the Medium Term Fiscal Strategy 2013-2016" (OG 222/A/12-11-2012)-article 1, sub-papa.IA.1.III introduces **new conditions** for the grant of “long-term unemployed people benefit». From 1.1.2014 the benefit may be paid to persons between **20 and 66 years of age** and their family income does not exceed 10.000€ (increased by 586,08 € for every child under the age of 18). More information on the long-term unemployed people benefit provision (in relation to the above mentioned Law) will be provided by a Joint Ministerial Decision of the Ministry of Finance and the Ministry of Labour, Social Security and Welfare.

Family Allowances

A new scheme ‘**single child support allowance**’ is introduced replacing a number of family benefits which have been now abolished [special allowance for the third child / benefit to mothers, who has three children or more /life-long pension to mothers with more than 3 children/ lump sum grant for the birth of the third and every subsequent child]. The single child support allowance shall be paid taking into account the number of dependent children, the equivalence scale, the equivalent income and the income category of the family [subpara IA2- Law 4093/2012]

Social assistance: special assistance for large family

The ‘special allowance of 500 euros for each child per year’, established as an additional benefit for families who have three dependent children or more, based on family income criteria [family income up to forty-five thousand (45,000) euros for families with three children, forty-eight thousand (48,000) euros for families with four children, increased by four thousand (4,000) euros for each additional child [art.40, Law 4141/2013[OG 81A/5.4.13].

Pregnancy and post-natal period benefit

A maternity allowance shall be granted to **female self-employed workers** enabling temporary interruptions in their occupational activity, owing to pregnancy or motherhood, for at least 14 weeks, according to the article 6 of Law 4097/2012 (OG 235, A’, 3.12.2012)

Social insurance contribution scale

The Greek Government enacted legislation to reduce IKA social security contribution rates for employers. Law 4093/12 [subpara IA.6, para 9,10,11, art.1] introduces the **reduction of social contributions** to IKA by 1.1 percentage points,-application since 1/11/12 (abolition of employer contributions for OEK,OEE)

EKAS (social solidarity benefit for pensioners) (See above 4.Social assistance)

Concerning the Social solidarity benefit for pensioners (EKAS), according to the law 4093/2012, there is an increase of the age limit of the person eligible for the benefit from 60 to 65, which shall apply starting with 1.1.2014. The above age limit is not required for children who receive pension due to the death of a parent, but they receive it until they reach the age set by the legislation. The said benefit is also paid to persons with a disability rate of 80% or more.

From 1.1.2014, the before mentioned extended age eligibility criterion (from 60 to 65 years old), is also valid for low income pensioners of public sector (law 4151/2013, article 4 para8 case c).

Pilot program for a minimum guaranteed income

The program for a minimum guaranteed income has been established by law 4093/2012. It is a pilot program aiming to cope with extreme forms of poverty and optimize the methodology for policies that concern social exclusion. The program will work complementary to the existing policies for combating poverty and social exclusion, working as an ultimate welfare safety net for individuals and families facing extreme poverty. In addition, it aims to function not only as an income support for its beneficiaries, but it will be connected to reintegration policies.

The program will begin in 2014 and will be implemented initially in two regions of the country with different socio-economic characteristics. The available resources for year 2014 rise up to 20 million euros.

A Joint Ministerial Decision signed by the Ministries of Finance and Labor, Social Security and Welfare will determine the exact form of the program, in particular :

- a. The beneficiaries of the program
- b. The level of minimum guaranteed income for individuals and families
- c. The procedures to enter the program and receive the income support that will cover the gap between the real income of the beneficiary and the minimum guaranteed income
- d. The competent public services and the two regions of the country to be selected.

Towards implementing the above policy, the Ministry of Labour, Social Security and Welfare has already formed a Committee with the participation of the Ministry of Finance that will prepare and submit a plan for a Joint Ministerial Decision.”

B) On 23.07.2013 the new Income Tax Code was adopted (Act No. 4172/2013, O.G. 167^A) regulating the new framework for the taxation of the income of natural persons and legal entities. It applies to income generated and expenses incurred in the years starting from 1st of January 2014 onwards.

12.2 Future policy changes announced since 1st July 2013

On 23.07.2013 the new Income Tax Code was adopted (Act No. 4172/2013, O.G. 167A) regulating the new framework for the taxation of the income of natural persons and legal entities. It applies to income generated and expenses incurred in the years starting from 1st of January 2014 onwards.

Social assistance : health sector

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2013**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (<http://www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives>)

Policy initiatives in order to reduce the health insurance gap has been decided. It includes a reduction in the days of insurance payments required for full medical coverage, a temporary extension of health coverage for the unemployed, the creation of a “Health Voucher” system (implemented since September 2013 - <http://www.eopyy.gov.gr/Article/DisplayArticle?id=2320caba-cce8-48b7-a9fa-4b2546d21dc0>), ensuring free access for people who have lost eligibility for health insurance and their families to primary healthcare services.